

# Global Superstore Executive Summary

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Tools Used: Power BI, DAX, Power Query, Excel

Dataset: Global Superstore | FY2011–2014 | 4 product categories | 13 regions

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## Executive Summary

Global Superstore generated \$12.64M in sales and \$1.47M in net profit, with an overall profit margin of 11.61%. While the business is profitable overall, the analysis identified several areas where profit is being reduced through loss-making products, heavy discounting, and regional performance differences.

Technology is the strongest profit contributor, while Furniture accounts for most of the company's losses. Nearly one-third of all orders generate negative profit, and higher discount levels consistently reduce profitability. The analysis also shows that the Consumer segment and Standard Class shipping contribute the highest overall profit.

Based on these findings, the recommended priorities are to review Furniture pricing, strengthen discount controls, investigate regional losses, and focus on retaining high-value customers.

## Business Question

The objective of this analysis was to understand what drives profitability across the business and identify opportunities to improve financial performance.

The project focused on four business questions:

- Where is profit generated across categories, products, and regions?
- Where are losses occurring, and what is causing them?
- How do discounts affect profitability?
- Which customers and operational factors contribute most to profit?

## Key Findings

### **Finding 1: Technology is the strongest profit contributor.**

Technology generated \$664K in profit, making it the company's highest-performing category. In contrast, Furniture recorded an overall loss despite strong sales, with the Tables sub-category contributing approximately \$64K in losses.

This suggests that profits from Technology are offsetting losses in Furniture rather than reflecting consistent profitability across all product categories.

### **Finding 2: Nearly one-third of all orders are unprofitable.**

Approximately 30% of all orders generated negative profit, resulting in total losses of about \$921K. Most of these losses came from Furniture, while the Central region recorded the highest regional losses at approximately \$202K.

This indicates that the company's losses are concentrated in specific categories and regions rather than being evenly distributed across the business.

**Finding 3: Higher discounts reduce profitability.**

The average discount across all orders was 14.3%. Orders with discounts above 30% consistently recorded negative profit margins, while orders with little or no discount remained significantly more profitable.

The analysis suggests that discount levels have a direct impact on profitability and should be reviewed before approval.

**Finding 4: Consumer customers generate the highest profit.**

The Consumer segment generated approximately \$749K in profit, outperforming both Corporate and Home Office customers.

Standard Class shipping also produced the highest overall profit, while average delivery time remained at four days, suggesting that faster shipping did not have a meaningful impact on overall profitability.

## Recommendations

1. **Review pricing for the Tables sub-category.** Tables generated the largest losses in the business despite continued sales. Reviewing pricing, product costs, and discounting for this sub-category should be a priority.
2. **Review the current discount strategy.** The analysis shows that profitability decreases as discount levels increase, particularly on heavily discounted orders. Management should review existing discount policies to ensure discounts improve sales without reducing overall profit.
3. **Investigate losses in the Central region.** The Central region recorded the highest regional losses. A more detailed review of products, customers, and pricing decisions in this region may help identify the underlying causes.
4. **Strengthen relationships with high-value customers.** The Consumer segment generated the highest overall profit. Retaining these customers and understanding what drives their purchasing behavior could support future revenue growth.
5. **Continue monitoring shipping performance.** Standard Class shipping generated the highest overall profit while maintaining an average delivery time of four days. Regular monitoring can help ensure service levels remain profitable as order volumes change.
6. **Introduce regular profitability reviews.** Monitoring profitability by product, region, and discount level can help identify emerging issues earlier and support better pricing decisions.

## Key Performance Indicator

| Metrics               | Value     |
|-----------------------|-----------|
| Total Sales           | \$12.64M  |
| Net Profit            | \$1.47M   |
| Profit Margin         | 11.61%    |
| Total Loss            | \$920.65K |
| Loss Order Rate       | 30%       |
| Average Shipping Cost | \$26.40   |

## Diagnosis by Focus Area

### Profit Leakage

- Total losses from unprofitable orders: \$920.65K
- Around 30% of orders generated negative profit.
- Furniture contributed the largest share of losses.
- The Central region recorded the highest regional losses.
- Tables was the worst-performing sub-category.

### Discount Strategy

- Average discount: 14.3%
- Profitability declined as discount levels increased.
- Orders with discounts above 30% generated the largest losses.
- Furniture received the highest average discounts.

### Customer & Operations

- Consumer segment generated the highest profit.
- Standard Class shipping delivered the highest overall profit.
- Average Order Value: \$505
- Average delivery time: 4 days

| Skill                     | Where Use                | Evidence                                                                                                                              |
|---------------------------|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Power BI Dashboard Design | All 4 dashboard pages    | Designed four interactive dashboard pages covering executive performance, profit leakage, discount analysis, and customer operations. |
| DAX Measures              | All KPI cards and charts | Created custom measures for Net Profit, Total Loss Abs, Profit Margin %, Loss Order Rate, and Discount ROI                            |
| Power Query               | Data preparation         | Cleaned and modeled source data before dashboard build                                                                                |
| Business Analysis         | All sections             | Framed 4 business questions; produced prioritized, quantified recommendations per page                                                |

## Project Outcome

This analysis identified the company's main sources of profit, highlighted areas where profit is being lost, and showed how discounting affects overall performance. The dashboard gives management a simple way to monitor profitability, investigate losses, and support pricing and operational decisions using data rather than assumptions.

## About Me

Victoria Johnson

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I have over four years of experience supporting B2B sales operations in the building materials industry. That experience led me to develop skills in Power BI, SQL, Excel, DAX, and Power Query, with a focus on using data to solve business problems and support better decision-making. I'm currently seeking opportunities in Revenue Operations, Business Intelligence, Sales Operations, and Data Analytics.